

Digital Dark Platform

Comprehensive Project Documentation, Progress Report & Database Architecture

Project Overview: Digital Dark is a high-performance, luxury Shopify Google Ads & SEO growth agency web platform built with Django 6.1. It features a public client-facing portal, lead generation engine, staff management portal, superuser admin control panel, and dynamic content management system.

1. Implementation & Progress Report

This section details the start-to-finish process of technical enhancements and design implementations executed on the Digital Dark codebase:

- **Route Bug Resolution (/case-studies/):** Resolved a *NoReverseMatch* server crash on */case-studies/* by updating template URL reverse tags to properly supply slug arguments for dynamic case studies.
- **Superuser & Staff Login Redesign:** Implemented 60fps HTML5 Canvas real-time background particle and ambient bubble animations for */control/login/* and */control/staff/login/*. Fixed text contrast issues for input labels, headings, and focus states.
- **Sticky Top Navbar Enhancements:** Upgraded header navigation styling in *styles.css* with *rgba(247, 241, 222, 0.96)* glassmorphism blur, copper gradient active pills, and high-contrast button styling.
- **Free Course Form Redesign (/free-course/):** Lightened the dark form container into a luxury cream bubble card (*#FFFDF8*, *border-radius: 36px*), integrated floating ambient CSS bubbles, and formatted required headline and subhead texts.
- **Database Seeding & Test Verification:** Executed initial data seeding via *seed_initial_data.py* and verified 200 OK status codes across all public and admin endpoints.

2. User Roles & Access Control Matrix

Role Name	Access Level & Portal	System Permissions & Detailed Capabilities
Customer / Public Visitor	Public Site (Unauthenticated)	• Browse agency growth services and detailed service pages. • Read Shopify case studies and organic growth metrics. • Filter blog articles by categories and perform search queries. • Download PDF growth playbooks (triggers lead creation). • Submit free growth course enrollment form. • Submit general contact and store audit request forms.
Staff Member	Staff Portal (/control/staff/)	• Restricted staff authentication portal (<i>is_staff=True</i>). • View incoming client leads and detailed lead notes. • Draft new blog articles (status forced to 'draft' or 'review'). • Edit own blog drafts and submit for admin review. • Submit draft case studies and downloadable guides.

Superuser Admin	Control Panel (/control/)	• Master superuser portal (is_superuser=True). • Complete lead pipeline management & CSV export. • Full user management (create, edit, activate/deactivate staff). • Blog moderation: publish, edit, or delete any post. • Case study & service CRUD management. • Global site settings & legal pages configuration.
-----------------	---------------------------	--

3. Database Architecture & Model Schemas

The Digital Dark platform utilizes SQLite (relational database engine) managed via Django ORM. Below is the full attribute specification for every model entity:

Model Entity: Lead (public.Lead)

Description: Captures customer lead inquiries, free course signups, PDF playbook downloads, and newsletter subscriptions.

Field Name	Data Type	Key / Constraint	Description
id	BigAutoField	PK, Auto	Primary Key unique identifier.
name	CharField(150)	Optional, Default=""	Full name of prospect user.
email	EmailField	Required	Email address of lead.
message	TextField	Optional, Default=""	Customer inquiry text message.
source	CharField(20)	Choices, Default='contact'	Inquiry origin ('newsletter', 'guide', 'course', 'contact').
status	CharField(20)	Choices, Default='new'	Lead pipeline state ('new', 'contacted', 'qualified', 'closed').
notes	TextField	Optional, Default=""	Internal staff / admin follow-up notes.
created_at	DateTimeField	Auto Now Add	Timestamp when record created.
updated_at	DateTimeField	Auto Now	Timestamp of last modification.

Model Entity: Category (public.Category)

Description: Taxonomy categories for organizing blog posts and educational content.

Field Name	Data Type	Key / Constraint	Description
id	BigAutoField	PK, Auto	Primary Key unique identifier.
name	CharField(100)	Required	Display name of category.
slug	SlugField	Unique, Auto Slug	URL-friendly slug generated from name.

Model Entity: BlogPost (public.BlogPost)

Description: Stores editorial blog posts, growth case articles, and CRO insights.

Field Name	Data Type	Key / Constraint	Description
id	BigAutoField	PK, Auto	Primary Key unique identifier.
title	CharField(255)	Required	Article title.
slug	SlugField	Unique, Auto Slug	URL slug identifier.
author	ForeignKey(User)	FK (auth_user.id)	Author relation (Cascade delete).
category	ForeignKey(Category)	FK (Category.id), Null	Category relation (Set Null on delete).
excerpt	TextField	Optional	Brief preview text summary.
body	TextField	Required	Full content text of post.
featured_image	CharField(500)	Optional	Image URL / path.
status	CharField(20)	Choices, Default='draft'	Publish state ('draft', 'review', 'published').
published_at	DateTimeField	Null, Optional	Timestamp when post published.
created_at	DateTimeField	Auto Now Add	Creation timestamp.
updated_at	DateTimeField	Auto Now	Last modification timestamp.

Model Entity: CaseStudy (public.CaseStudy)

Description: Stores Shopify merchant growth proof, metrics, and strategy breakdowns.

Field Name	Data Type	Key / Constraint	Description
id	BigAutoField	PK, Auto	Primary Key unique identifier.
title	CharField(255)	Required	Case study headline.
slug	SlugField	Unique, Auto Slug	Unique URL slug.
client_name	CharField(150)	Required	Name of Shopify merchant / brand.
summary	TextField	Required	Executive overview summary.
result	CharField(255)	Required	Key metric highlight (e.g. '+340% ROAS').
story	TextField	Required	Detailed strategy and execution text.
image	CharField(500)	Optional	Banner image URL / path.
status	CharField(20)	Choices, Default='draft'	Publication status ('draft', 'review', 'published').
created_at	DateTimeField	Auto Now Add	Creation timestamp.

Model Entity: Guide (public.Guide)

Description: Downloadable PDF growth playbooks and lead magnets.

Field Name	Data Type	Key / Constraint	Description
id	BigAutoField	PK, Auto	Primary Key unique identifier.
title	CharField(255)	Required	Guide title.
slug	SlugField	Unique, Auto Slug	URL slug.
description	TextField	Required	Summary of guide content.
pdf_file	FileField	Upload to 'guides/'	Uploaded PDF file asset.
pdf_url	CharField(500)	Optional	Direct static URL to PDF.
created_at	DateTimeField	Auto Now Add	Creation timestamp.

Model Entity: Service (public.Service)

Description: Core agency growth services rendered on public pages.

Field Name	Data Type	Key / Constraint	Description
id	BigAutoField	PK, Auto	Primary Key unique identifier.
title	CharField(200)	Required	Service title.
slug	SlugField	Unique, Auto Slug	URL slug.
short_description	TextField	Required	Card summary text.
full_description	TextField	Required	Comprehensive methodology text.
icon	CharField(100)	Default='fa-rocket'	FontAwesome icon class name.
order	IntegerField	Default=0	Display ordering integer.

Model Entity: SiteSetting & LegalPage (public)

Description: Global configuration key-values and legal terms pages.

Field Name	Data Type	Key / Constraint	Description
key (SiteSetting)	CharField(100)	Unique	Global setting key name.
value (SiteSetting)	TextField	Optional	Setting value.
slug (LegalPage)	SlugField	Unique	Legal page key ('privacy', 'terms').
content (LegalPage)	TextField	Required	Legal page terms content.

4. Project End-to-End Execution Flow

The application follows a clean 3-tier architecture separating Public Prospecting, Staff Pipeline Management, and Superuser Administration:

- **Phase A (Lead Acquisition Flow):** Public visitor accesses site → submits Free Course or Guide Download form → Django view validates CSRF token → creates Lead object with source='course' and status='new' → renders success message.

- **Phase B (Staff Review Flow):** Staff member logs in at /control/staff/login/ → authenticated session validated → accesses Staff Dashboard → views new lead inquiries and adds follow-up notes → drafts blog post or case study (status set to 'review').
- **Phase C (Superuser Approval & Export Flow):** Admin logs in at /control/login/ → reviews pending drafts → publishes articles to public site → filters lead pipeline and exports CSV report via /control/leads/export-csv/.

End of Technical Documentation & Progress Report - Digital Dark Platform